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Sample 3 – Twining & Waling Instructions

The handout is a supplement to class discussions and demonstrations

Prepare Spokes and Weavers

1. Cut the ten spokes to 40".
 - Use #4 (2.75 mm) round reed for spokes
 - #2 (1.72 mm) round reed for the weavers.
2. Soak the spokes and weavers.
 - Soak #4 for about three minutes.
 - Soak #2 for about 1 minute.
 - If the reed is in the water for too long, it will become mushy; you do not want mushy reed!
3. Use a spray bottle to keep spokes and weavers damp.
 - Keep the reed damp so it remains pliable; if it is too dry, it will break.
4. After soaking, keep the reed damp (not overly wet) by placing it in a towel or plastic bag.
 - To prevent mold from growing, you must let the reed completely dry when you are done working.

Base

1. As you make the base, you will look at the bottom of the base and weave clockwise.
 - Do the opposite if you are left-handed.
2. Divide the spokes into two groups of 5
 - Mark the center of both groups with a pencil.
3. Make a cross by laying one group of 5 spokes over the other.
4. Filling - One-Strand Slew Technique
 - Using a #2 reed, weave under the 5 spokes on the bottom and over the 5 spokes on the top.
 - Go around clockwise four times (if you are left-handed, go counterclockwise).
5. Begin the Japanese weave to open the spokes; weave over 2 under 1.
 - When the base measures 5" across, cut the weaver and tuck it next to the left of the right spoke.

Walls

- Mark spoke #1 (color the tip with a permanent marker)
- Each row should lay directly on top of the previous row.
- It is easier to control the walls of the form if you are standing.
- Hold the basket against your stomach to keep the walls horizontal (try to control the walls from expanding outwards).

1. Upset the spokes by pinching each spoke with a pair of needle-nosed pliers. Then use your hands to bend the spokes vertically.
2. **Three-Rod Waling**
 - Secure one weaver to the right side of spokes 1, 2, and 3.
 - Pinch the weaver to keep it from breaking.
 - Weave over 2 under 1.
 - Weave 1 1/2" of three-rod waling.
 - Cut and secure weaver #3 by tucking it to the left side of the right spoke.
3. **Twining**
 - Secure one weaver to the right side of spoke #1 and one weaver to the right side of spoke #2.
 - Twine with two weavers for 1/2" (4 times around).
4. **Four-Rod Waling**
 - Secure one weaver to the right side of spokes 1, 2, 3, and 4.
 - Weave over 3 under 1.
 - Weave 1 1/2" of four-rod waling.
 - Cut and secure weavers 3 and 4 by tucking weaver 3 to the left side of spoke 3 and tucking weaver 4 along the left side of spoke 4.
5. **Twining**
 - Secure one weaver to the right side of spoke #1 and one weaver to the right side of spoke #2.
 - Twine with two weavers for 1/2" (4 times around).
6. **Five-Rod Waling or Three-Rod Waling going in the opposite direction**
 - Secure one weaver to the right side of spokes 1, 2, 3, 4, and 5.
 - Weave over 3 under 2.
 - Weave 1 1/2" of four-rod waling.
 - Cut and secure weavers 3 and 4 by tucking weaver 3 to the left side of spoke 3 and tucking weaver 4 along the left side of spoke 4.

Rim

1. Soak the top of the basket.
2. Pinch each spoke so that they will bend without breaking.
3. **Row 1**
 - Using a Sharpie, color the tip of the first two spokes (the first spoke should already be marked). For example, color spoke #1 black, spoke #2 red.
 - Spoke #1 goes around spokes #2 and #3, spoke #2 goes around spokes #3 and #4, spoke #3 goes around spokes #4 and #5, etc.
 - Tuck the second to last spoke behind the first spoke.
 - Tuck the last spoke under spokes numbers 1 and 2.

4. Row 2

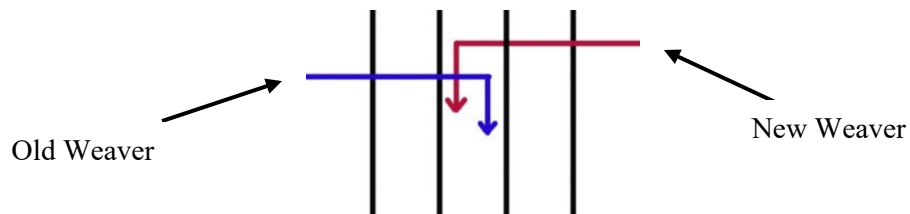
- Same weave structure as row number 1.

5. Row 3

- If the spokes are long enough, you can go around a third and fourth time.

Ending & Adding Weavers

1. Pinch the end of the old weaver and insert it in the open space on the left side of the spoke it would generally go behind.
2. Pinch the new weaver and insert it in the open space next to the old weaver.



Helpful Hints

1. The spokes are thicker in diameter than the weavers.
2. Spokes must remain straight throughout the weaving process.
3. Leave no more than $\frac{1}{2}$ " - $\frac{3}{4}$ " between the spokes to create a sturdy form.
 - More space will result in a flimsy basket.
4. Dye the reed or completed basket with instant coffee.
 - Dissolve instant coffee in hot water.
 - Pour the coffee over the basket or reed. Continue pouring over the reed until the desired value is achieved.
5. Once the basket is dry, you can preserve the basket by spraying it with Weaver's Stain (Danish or Tung oil urethane).

Vocabulary

- Base - the bottom of the basket.
- Rattan – comes from a tropical climbing vine and is used to make reed.
- Reed - the inside portion of the rattan vine.
- Rim - the top edge of the basket.
- 3 Rod Wale or 3 Rod Rand or Triple Twining - working with three weavers sequentially.
- Spokes or stakes - the upright or vertical elements or warp comprising the framework of a basket.
- Twining or Pairing - twisting two horizontal weavers around a spoke.
- Weavers - the horizontal weft elements used to weave the sides of the basket.